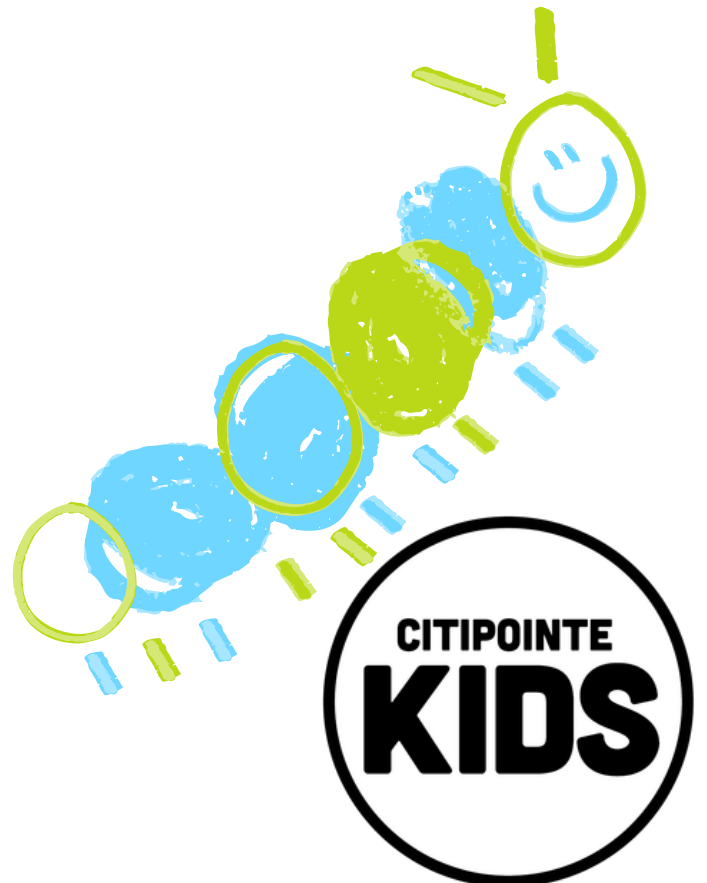
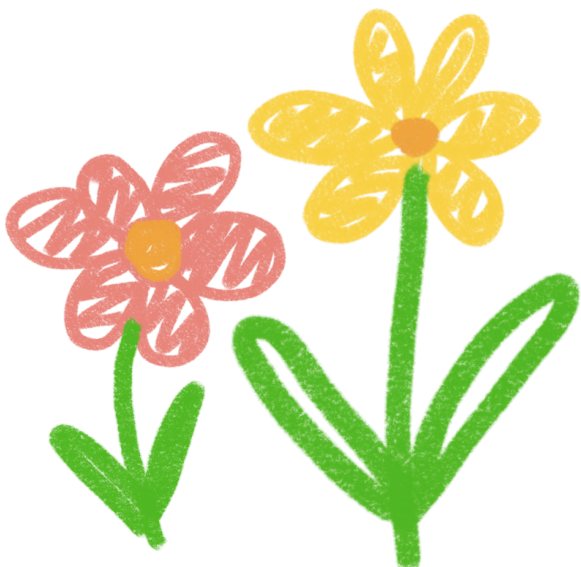




CITIPOINTE KIDS

Leadership Essentials

THIS IS WHO WE ARE.
THIS IS WHERE WE ARE GOING.
THIS IS EVERYTHING YOU NEED
TO KNOW.



Dear Team,

Welcome to Citipointe Kids. We are so grateful that you've chosen to invest your time, heart, and energy into serving the next generation. Every week, children walk through our doors ready to be seen, known, and loved — and you play a vital role in creating that environment.

As part of our commitment to creating a safe and trustworthy ministry, all new volunteers serving with children or youth must complete a background check and read our code of conduct before they begin serving. These steps help us protect our kids, support our leaders, and uphold the highest standards of care. You can learn more about this in our safety standards.

This Training Manual has been created to equip you with everything you need to serve confidently and consistently. Inside, you'll find our policies, procedures, expectations, and safety standards. These aren't just rules on paper — they exist to protect our kids, empower our leaders, and ensure that every family experiences excellence and care. Clear guidelines help us create a ministry where children feel safe, parents feel confident, and leaders feel supported.

If at any time an issue arises — whether it involves a child, a parent, or a leader — and something isn't aligning with our guidelines, we ask that you speak directly with the Kids Director. Keeping leadership informed allows us to respond quickly, support you well, and take any necessary next steps with families or leaders. You are never expected to navigate difficult situations alone. We lead together.

Thank you for saying “yes” to this calling. Thank you for showing up with joy, humility, and a heart to serve. What you do matters deeply — not just for today, but for the future these children will grow into. We are honored to serve alongside you.

With gratitude,

Citipointe Kids Leadership

Citipointe Kids Leadership Essentials Manual

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Kids Host Team

First Impressions & Family Support

You are the first impressions team for both kids and families as they enter church. Your role is incredibly important — you set the tone for every family's experience from the moment they arrive. While you don't need to wear a Kids Ministry shirt, we do ask that you wear the Kids Host Team "I Am Here to Serve" lanyard. This helps parents easily identify you as someone who can assist them.

Core Responsibilities

- Greeting families warmly and making them feel seen
- Assisting with check-in using the iPads
- Troubleshooting simple tech issues (including rebooting iPads if needed)
- Offering high-fives, encouragement, and a joyful welcome to kids
- Helping families get to the correct age-appropriate rooms
- Offering practical support (carrying bags, helping parents get settled, etc.)

Kids Host Team

Supporting New Families

If you are serving at the New Families Check-In Table, your role includes:

1. Welcome & Connect Card
 - Greet the family warmly and invite them to fill out a Connect Card for their child. Ask them to complete as much information as possible for both the child and the parent.
2. Assist the Child (if needed)
 - While the parent is filling out the card, you may:
 - Ask a second Host Leader to help engage or supervise the child
 - Begin preparing the child's security tags
3. Create Security Tags
 - Each child's tag should include:
 - First Name
 - Last Name
 - Allergies
 - Security Code

You will create the security code (e.g., A00 511) and copy the same code onto the parent's pick-up tag. Place the child's sticker on their clothing. If there is any important information — such as an older sibling, allergies, special instructions, or helpful notes — write it clearly on the Connect Card.

Welcome Pack & Room Drop-Off

Give the parent a Kids Welcome Pack and place a HEY! I'M NEW sticker on the child. Walk the family to the appropriate room and let them know that you have their contact information and will message them if you need to reach them during the service.

Coordinator

Coordinators carry the strength of the day. You oversee the flow of Sunday operations, support volunteers, and ensure every environment is safe, welcoming, and excellent.

Core Responsibilities

- Maintain a high standard of excellence across all Kids Ministry spaces
- Support volunteers, teachers, and new families
- Ensure safety procedures are followed at all times
- Oversee check-in, room readiness, and mid-service needs

To-Do List

- Check the Mothers Feeding Room & Families Lounge — Ensure both spaces are clean and welcoming.
- Confirm service streaming — Use the church iPhone to screen-mirror YouTube onto the Mothers Feeding Room TV. Also check the Families Lounge stream and adjust volume as needed.
- Refresh water pitchers & cups — Visit each Kids room to refill pitchers and confirm cup supply.
- Verify volunteer shirts — All volunteers must wear Kids volunteer shirts. If they don't have one, direct them to the Coordinators Closet.
- Ensure Watchman coverage — Confirm a Watchman is present at the start of service and again at 10:50am when kids go outside.
- Host at Check-In — Be present at the front to welcome families and support arrival flow.
- Assist new families & volunteers — Step in wherever needed to support smooth check-in and transitions.
- Close Kids Wing doors at 10:15am — This ensures safety once service begins. Reopen the doors once the band returns to close the service.
- Complete Classroom Headcounts — Visit each classroom, record the headcount, and give it to the counter.
- Check on Lead Teachers — Ensure they have what they need and feel supported.
- Contact parents when needed — If a child needs their parent (behavior, diaper change, upset, etc.):
 - Look up parent info on the church iPad
 - Send a polite message asking them to come
 - Remind them to bring their security tag
- Handle mid-service parent pick-ups — Parents must present a matching security tag to collect their child.
 - Unlock the door
 - Walk them to the classroom
 - Verify the tag If the tag does not match or they are not the parent, the child cannot be released. Safety is our highest priority.

Kids Team Leaders

We are so thankful for you. You are the true hands and feet of Jesus, faithfully serving week in and week out. At Citipointe Kids, our heart is that every child and every family would feel seen, valued, and experience the love of God through the way we lead, welcome, and care for them each week.

As the Room Leader, we encourage you to have lots of fun with the kids while also helping them learn about God. Our heart is to see kids saved, healed, set free, disciplined, equipped, empowered, and growing in serving. This is Kingdom work, and you play a vital role in it.

Age Group Rooms

- Red Room — 12–18 months (must be walking)
- Yellow Room — 18–24 months
- Orange Room 24– 36 year-olds
- Blue Room — 4 & 5-year-olds
- Green Room — 6 & 7-year-olds
- Purple Room — 8–12-year-olds

Supervision Expectations

In Citipointe Kids, we follow the Two Adult Rule:

- There must always be two or more volunteers present for any activity involving contact with or supervision of children. The best-case scenario is two or more screened and unrelated volunteers in each classroom or enclosed area.
 - This protects our kids, protects our leaders, and ensures accountability and safety at all times.

Appropriate Behavior with Children

Leaders should avoid any behavior that could appear inappropriate or create misunderstanding.

This includes:

- Sitting older children on your lap
- Kissing or embracing children
- Physical contact that could be misinterpreted

Our goal is to create a safe, respectful, and trustworthy environment where children feel loved and protected.

Junior Helpers

Role Overview

Junior Helpers (ages 13–17) serve by assisting the Room Leader with children who may need extra support, helping with activities, and preparing lesson materials. Their role is supportive, not supervisory.

Supervision

Junior Helpers must be accompanied by a Leader at all times and serve under the direction and supervision of the Room Leader for that service.

Expectations

- Must wear a Kids Volunteer Shirt while serving
- May not use their phones during service
- Should model attentiveness, kindness, and teamwork

Junior Helpers play an important part in creating a safe, fun, and Christ-centered environment for our kids.

Policies

Sunday Volunteer Arrival & Huddle Policy

Arrival Expectations

- All volunteers serving in Citipointe Kids on Sundays must be on campus and present in the Kids Wing hallway by 9:00 AM for Team Huddle.

Before Team Huddle begins, volunteers must:

- Place all belongings in the room where they are serving
- Check in at the volunteer station
- Put on their name tag

Being prepared before huddle ensures we start the morning unified and ready to serve families with excellence.

Kids Team Huddle – 9:00 AM

At 9:00 AM, all Kids volunteers gather in the Kids Wing hallway for a brief team huddle focused on vision, prayer, expectations, and alignment for the day.

Church-Wide Team Huddle – 9:20 AM

At 9:20 AM, all serving teams across Citipointe Church meet together in the foyer for the large All-Team Huddle.

Return to Classrooms

Immediately after the All-Team Huddle, volunteers must go directly to their assigned classrooms to prepare for kids' arrival.

To maintain safety and readiness:

- Do not remain in the foyer talking
- Do not wander to other areas of the building
- Head straight to your room so you are present, prepared, and ready to welcome families

Our goal is to create a safe, excellent, and welcoming environment from the moment the first child arrives.

Citipointe Kid's Volunteer Shirt

All Kids Team volunteers are required to wear a Citipointe Volunteer Shirt while serving. If you need one, you can purchase it from the Kids Director. Wearing your shirt helps parents and kids easily identify who is leading in our environments.

Phone Policy

We are a No Phone Zone in Citipointe Kids. Phones should not be used during serving time unless there is an emergency. We want to model focus, honor God, and give our kids our full attention.

This applies to kids as well. Kindly encourage them to put their phones away. If a child repeatedly struggles with this, notify the Kids Director so a solution can be put in place.

Open Door Policy

Classroom doors must remain open at all times, while the barn doors stay closed to maintain safety and visibility.

Restroom Policy

- Children should use the classroom restroom when available.
- If a child is taking longer than expected, knock and call their name.
- If a child needs assistance, ask the Coordinator to contact the parent or guardian.

Potty Training

Leaders may assist potty-training children only with the restroom door open. Safety and accountability take priority over privacy in these moments. If a leader feels uncomfortable with a messy situation, the parent can be contacted through the classroom iPad.

Note: Adults may use classroom restrooms when needed.

Diaper Policy

Leaders are not permitted to change diapers. If a child needs a diaper change:

- Notify the Coordinator
- The Coordinator will contact the parent/guardian
- Once the parent's security tag is verified, they will take the child to be changed and return them to the room

First Aid

Every Kids room has a first aid kit in the closet. For minor scrapes, bumps, and small injuries, leaders may provide basic first aid and should notify the parent or guardian at pick-up. Learn more in the First Aid Guidelines.

For any injury that requires more than simple first aid — including anything involving a child's head — immediately notify the Coordinator. The parent or guardian will be contacted right away, and if necessary, an ambulance will be called.

If a child requires medical attention from a professional, an incident report must be completed after the child has received care.

- Ensure the parent signs the report
- Reports are located in the Kids Coordinators Closet
- A Coordinator must be present as a third-party witness

Citipointe Church does not administer prescription or non-prescription medication to children in our care. Exceptions may be made for children with life-threatening conditions (such as asthma or severe allergies).

Cleaning

Please help keep the room tidy throughout the service.

After service:

- Wipe down all surfaces
- Sanitize toys as needed (spray sanitizer or use wipes)
- Return toys, supplies, and activities to their proper places

Emergency Lockdown

A lockdown is initiated when there is an active threat or imminent danger.

Lockdown Procedure

- Alarm sounds
- Immediately lock all doors
- Two-minute standby— stay alert and wait for direction
 - Safety team will verify via intercom or text whether it is a test, drill, or active situation
- If not verified within two minutes:
 - Turn lights off
 - Move children to the hard corner (the area not visible from the hallway or line of sight of a threat)

Emergency Contacts:

- Dan Terry — 628-259-9460
- Joel Ramsey — 615-979-4933

Emergency Exit Procedure

Each Kids classroom has an emergency key located in the clear wall-mounted file holder near the door.

- Place the lanyard around your neck
- Stay calm
- Do a headcount using the clipboard roster
- Lead children to the nearest safe exit

Discipline Policy

Citipointe Church does not condone or administer corporal punishment under any circumstances — even if a parent gives permission.

This means:

- No spanking
- No grabbing
- No hitting
- No physical discipline of any kind

If you need support with a behavior situation, notify the Kids Director.

No matter the situation, remain calm, kind, and fair. Ask questions, listen well, and work toward a gentle, respectful resolution.

Violations of Policies & Procedures

Volunteers must promptly notify the Kids Director if they or another volunteer violate any policy or procedure.

Volunteers who become aware of a violation are responsible for taking appropriate steps to ensure future compliance. In some cases, this may require removing a volunteer from their position to maintain safety and integrity.

Safety

Arrival & Dismissal

Workers must arrive at their designated times and remain at their assigned post until every child has been picked up by an authorized parent or guardian. Children should never be released to find their parents or wait unattended.

When a Parent Is Needed

If a child is unsettled, needs a diaper change, or a parent is required for any reason:

1. Notify the Coordinator
2. The Coordinator will contact the parent/guardian
3. The parent will come to the door with their security sticker
4. The Lead Teacher must verify the sticker matches the child's security code before releasing the child

Once the child leaves, remove the child's sticker after checkout is complete.

Security Tag Policy

A child may only be released to the person with the matching security sticker. Do not release a child to anyone who says, "The parent told me I could get them." Safety always comes before convenience.

Parents may keep their sticker if they have multiple children in different rooms — simply verify the matching code.

Unauthorized Individuals

If someone is in the Kids Wing who is not a Pastor or Kids Team Leader serving that Sunday — and they do not need to be there — you have permission to kindly direct them to the lobby for assistance.

Drop-Off & Pick-Up

- Parents must drop off and pick up children at the classroom door
- All children must go to their age-appropriate rooms for safety and consistency

Outside Regulations

Before Going Outside

To ensure a smooth and safe transition outdoors:

- Make sure all children have had a bathroom break before going outside
- Ensure shoes are on
- All belongings stay inside
- Indoor toys remain in the classroom

Head Counts & Line-Up

Before leaving the room:

1. Update your class list
2. Take a head count
3. Line children up at the door
4. Do a name call to confirm everyone is present

No child should ever be left in a Citipointe Kids classroom unattended. Leaders must never prop open a classroom door in a way that allows a child to enter the room alone. When outside for dedicated play time, all children must be present.

Bathroom Needs Outside

Bathroom breaks should be completed before going outside. If a child needs to use the restroom while outside, follow the standard bathroom procedure.

Returning Inside

When your group is ready to return:

1. Let the Watchman know you are ready
2. They will communicate with your Coordinator to open your classroom door
3. Bring children back one group at a time
4. Line up, do a head count, and lead your class inside
5. Once inside, complete a final name call to ensure all children have returned

Missing Child

If you notice a child is missing at any point, notify your Coordinator immediately. They will alert the Watchman to initiate a security search.

Child Safety Code of Conduct

All administrators, employees, and volunteers of Citipointe Kids must sign this Code of Conduct to acknowledge that they have read, understood, and agree to follow all policies and expectations outlined here.

Citipointe Kids requires that all adults engage in safe, supportive, and respectful interactions with children at all times. The following outlines expectations for physical behavior, communication, general conduct, and reporting.

Physical Behaviors

Commitments

- I will reduce risk by following the Rule of Two, increasing accountability, and maintaining healthy boundaries.
- I will notify the Kids Director and obtain written parent permission before engaging in any ongoing extracurricular mentoring or one-on-one discipleship outside regular ministry settings, as outlined in the Child Protection Policy.
- I will not tolerate neglect, physical, emotional, or sexual abuse in any form.

Appropriate Physical Behavior

Physical contact must always be public, nonsexual, and respectful, such as:

- Pats on the back or shoulder
- Child-initiated or child-approved hugs
- Holding hands with a younger child for safety

Inappropriate Physical Behavior

The following behaviors are strictly prohibited:

- Slapping, shaking, pinching, hitting, punching, pushing, grabbing, kicking, spanking, or unnecessary restraint
- Patting or touching the buttocks
- Touching private body parts
- Any intimate, romantic, or sexual contact
- Inappropriate emotional attachment
- Possessing, viewing, or accessing pornography
- Involving a child in any pornographic activity

Communication

I will use caution and discretion in all verbal, nonverbal, and digital communication with children, including email, text, and social media. All communication must reflect professionalism, integrity, and the heart of ministry.

Verbal Communication

Appropriate:

- Positive reinforcement
- Loving correction with a clear teaching purpose
- Consistent, fair communication with all children

Inappropriate:

- Profanity or crude language
- Sexual innuendo or risqué jokes
- Yelling, threatening, ridiculing, shaming, humiliating, or degrading comments

Standards for Volunteer Behavior

Volunteers will:

- Treat all children with respect and provide safe and supportive interactions that foster children's social, emotional, and academic development.
- Fully cooperate with and participate in needed discussions about child safety.
- Comply with mandated reporter procedures required by the State of Tennessee.

Volunteers will not:

- Engage in any inappropriate behaviors outlined above.
- Use or be under the influence of alcohol, tobacco, or illicit drugs in the presence of children. Adults are expected to self-manage the use of prescription medications and to report any potential impairment risk to an administrator.
- Give individual children gifts (that other children in the class do not also have the opportunity to receive) without the knowledge of the children's caregivers.

Reporting

I will immediately report any reasonable suspicion, knowledge, and/or disclosure of the following to an administrator and, if merited, appropriate legal authorities:

- inappropriate behavior between an adult and child/children,
- significant misconduct by students or staff,
- violations of this policy by students or staff

Employee & Volunteer Attestation

I understand that children have intrinsic value as declared in scripture and deserve our respect, nurture, care, and protection. I understand the Bible is clear on warnings towards those who mistreat children. I am committed to treating children fairly regardless of race, gender, age, or religion.

My signature confirms that I have read the Citipointe Child/Youth Protection Policy and Citipointe Volunteer Child Policies and Safety Code of Conduct and commit to these expectations, regardless of differences in cultural background, family background, or personal convictions.

I understand the definitions of harassment and abuse as outlined in the online safety training and am familiar with the policies and protocols that all staff and volunteers must follow. I understand that any violation of this Code of Conduct or failure to report any violations may result in disciplinary action not excluding immediate dismissal from Citipointe Church. I understand that Citipointe Church will fully cooperate with proper legal authorities if allegations of abuse are made.

Signature: _____

Date: _____